



TWELVE PROMPTS FOR FAMILIES

Calm *Connection*

Conversation cards to help children feel heard, known, and safe.

PRINTABLE CARDS DR. GARGEE GADGIL

CONNECTION, NOT PERFORMANCE

Let curiosity lead the *conversation*.

Choose one card at an unhurried moment. Let everyone answer—including the adults. Listen without correcting, teaching, or rushing toward a solution.

1

Choose together

Invite your child to pick a card. Passing is always allowed.

2

Answer with honesty

Simple, age-appropriate honesty helps children see conversation as a shared space.

3

Stay with their answer

Try: “Tell me more,” “That makes sense,” or “Thank you for telling me.”

4

Close with warmth

A hug, a smile, or “I loved hearing that” can be enough.

01 · NOTICE

What was one tiny good thing in your day?

It can be as small as a tasty bite, a funny sound, or a kind look.

02 · FEEL

If your mood had a weather report, what would it say?

Sunny, cloudy, stormy, foggy—or something entirely your own.

03 · NEED

What helps you feel safe when a day is difficult?

Listen for the people, places, words, and routines that matter.

BONUS · FOR GROWN-UPS

What did your child say that you want to remember?

Write one sentence here:

04 · BELONG

When do you feel
most like
yourself?

There is no right setting, activity, or kind of
company.

05 · IMAGINE

If our family had a
secret
superpower, what
would it be?

Kindness? Making people laugh? Solving tricky
things together?

06 · REPAIR

What makes an
apology feel real
to you?

Words, changed actions, a hug, space—or
something else?

BONUS · FOR GROWN-UPS

Where can you
offer
understanding
before advice?

One moment I want to meet differently:

07 · COURAGE

What is something
hard that you
handled recently?

Notice the effort and the inner quality it took—not
only the result.

08 · SUPPORT

How can I make
this week feel a
little easier for
you?

Let the answer be practical, playful, emotional, or
beautifully small.

09 · JOY

What should we
do more often just
because it is fun?

Choose one idea you could genuinely make room
for.

BONUS · TOGETHER

One small plan we
want to make:

What: _____ When:

10 · BE KNOWN

What is something
you wish grown-
ups understood
better?

You do not have to agree in order to understand.

11 · GRATITUDE

What is one thing
someone in this
family does that
you appreciate?

Be as specific as you can.

12 · HOME

What makes our
home feel like
home to you?

A smell, a ritual, a person, a sound, a corner, or a
feeling.

KEEP CLOSE

You never have to
earn your place in
this family.

You are loved while learning, growing, trying,
resting, and beginning again.